

Code of Conduct

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1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour expected from all employees, consultants, and contractors within the organisation. It establishes clear expectations for professionalism, integrity, and respect in all work-related interactions.

The purpose of this policy is to promote a positive working environment, ensure consistent behaviour across the organisation, and protect both individuals and the organisation from misconduct, reputational risk, and legal issues.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all individuals working for or representing the organisation, including:

- employees
- consultants
- contractors
- temporary staff
- individuals working at client sites

The Code of Conduct applies in all work-related settings, including the office, remote working environments, client locations, and any professional events or communications.

3. Professional Behaviour

All individuals are expected to act in a professional manner at all times. This includes maintaining appropriate conduct in communication, behaviour, and decision-making.

Employees must:

- treat colleagues, clients, and stakeholders with respect
- communicate clearly and professionally
- maintain appropriate boundaries in workplace relationships
- represent the organisation positively in all interactions

Unprofessional behaviour, including disruptive conduct or inappropriate language, is not acceptable.

4. Integrity and Honesty

Integrity is a core value of the organisation. All employees must act honestly and ethically in all aspects of their work.

This includes:

- being truthful in communication and reporting
- not misrepresenting information or qualifications
- avoiding conflicts of interest
- making decisions that are in the best interests of the organisation

Employees must not engage in dishonest or misleading behaviour under any circumstances.

5. Respect and Inclusion

The organisation is committed to providing an inclusive and respectful workplace where all individuals are treated fairly.

Employees must:

- respect diversity in all its forms
- avoid discriminatory behaviour or language
- support an inclusive working environment
- challenge inappropriate behaviour where necessary

Any form of discrimination, harassment, bullying, or victimisation is strictly prohibited.

6. Communication Standards

All communication, whether verbal, written, or digital, must be appropriate, respectful, and professional.

Employees must:

- avoid offensive or inappropriate language
- communicate clearly and accurately
- use company communication tools responsibly
- ensure that messages represent the organisation appropriately

This applies to emails, internal messaging platforms, meetings, and any external communication.

7. Use of Company Resources

Company resources, including equipment, systems, and information, must be used responsibly and only for legitimate purposes.

Employees must:

- follow IT policies and security guidelines
- protect company and client data
- avoid misuse of systems or equipment
- report any issues or misuse

Unauthorised use of company resources is not permitted.

8. Confidentiality

Employees may have access to sensitive or confidential information. This must be handled with care and not disclosed without proper authorisation.

Confidential information includes:

- client data
- employee information
- business strategies and internal documents

Employees must ensure that such information is not shared, discussed, or exposed outside of authorised contexts.

9. Attendance and Reliability

Employees are expected to be reliable and fulfil their work responsibilities.

This includes:

- attending work as scheduled
- meeting deadlines and commitments
- communicating absences or delays appropriately
- managing time effectively

Consistent failure to meet expectations may be addressed through performance management processes.

10. Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict with professional responsibilities.

This includes:

- outside employment that affects performance
- personal relationships that influence decisions
- financial interests that may impact objectivity

Any potential conflicts must be disclosed to management.

11. Behaviour at Work and External Events

Employees are expected to maintain professional standards not only during normal work hours but also at work-related events, including:

- meetings
- client interactions
- training sessions
- social events linked to the organisation

Behaviour that could harm the organisation's reputation or relationships is not acceptable.

12. Reporting Concerns

Employees are encouraged to report any concerns regarding behaviour that may breach this Code of Conduct.

This includes:

- inappropriate or unprofessional conduct
- harassment or discrimination
- unethical or dishonest behaviour

Concerns should be raised through appropriate channels, such as line managers or HR.

13. Disciplinary Action

Failure to comply with this Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action. The level of action will depend on the seriousness of the breach.

Possible outcomes include:

- formal warnings
- restriction of responsibilities
- termination of employment or contract

Serious breaches may also involve legal action where applicable.

14. Responsibility and Acknowledgement

All employees are responsible for understanding and following this Code of Conduct. Individuals may be required to confirm that they have read and agreed to comply with the policy.

Managers are responsible for promoting and enforcing these standards within their teams.

15. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure it remains relevant and effective.

Updates will be communicated to employees, and the latest version will be accessible through the company portal.